SHARK TANK + OVERPLAY

Making an interactive gaming product understandable in seconds

ROLE: End-to-end Product Designer
Overplay — Interactive Gaming Platform
Product Strategy · UX Design · Interaction Design · AI-Ready Product Thinking

OVERVIEW

I led the end-to-end experience design of Overplay, connecting the digital gaming experience with its live presentation on Shark Tank.
My work covered product strategy, UX architecture, user journeys, gameplay interactions, mobile experiences, and the design of the live demonstration.

The challenge was to translate an innovative interactive gaming concept into an experience that people could understand instantly, engage with intuitively, and recognize as a new way to experience video.

THE CHALLENGE

Overplay introduced a new way to experience video: transforming passive viewing into interactive gameplay. For its Shark Tank presentation, the challenge was to communicate that value within a short, high-pressure live demonstration while allowing judges and viewers to understand and experience the product immediately.

FOUR KEY DESIGN CHALLENGES

01 — Researching New Possibilities
Use AI-assisted research and ideation to explore emerging interaction patterns, investigate opportunities, and generate directions for the product experience.

02 — Simplifying Complexity
Translate unfamiliar gameplay mechanics into intuitive interactions that required little explanation.

03 — Designing for Engagement
Connect the mobile experience with the live demonstration, creating a compelling journey for both participants and viewers.

04 — Designing for Live Performance
Ensure the experience remained clear, reliable, and engaging under the constraints of a high-pressure television environment.

CORE UX QUESTION

How might we make an entirely new interactive gaming experience intuitive enough to understand and compelling enough to engage with in seconds?

PRODUCT STRATEGY

Simplify. Clarify. Engage.

The strategy was to turn a complex interactive gaming platform into an experience that felt immediate, intuitive, and engaging.
AI-assisted research and ideation supported the exploration of interaction concepts and possible experience directions. These explorations informed a focused design strategy built around three principles.

01 — SIMPLIFY THE EXPERIENCE
Reduce interaction complexity and prioritize the essential actions users needed to understand and play.

02 — CLARIFY THE JOURNEY
Structure the demonstration around a simple narrative:
SEE → PLAY → COMPETE
Make each step communicate a clear purpose and naturally lead to the next.

03 — DESIGN FOR ENGAGEMENT
Create custom games for judge participation and a camera-friendly leader-board experience that made competition easy to follow for the live audience.

EXPERIENCE DESIGN

The experience was designed as one connected journey, bringing together mobile gameplay, live participation, and broadcast storytelling.

The goal was to make the product tangible: not just explain what Overplay could do, but let people experience it.

THREE EXPERIENCE LAYERS

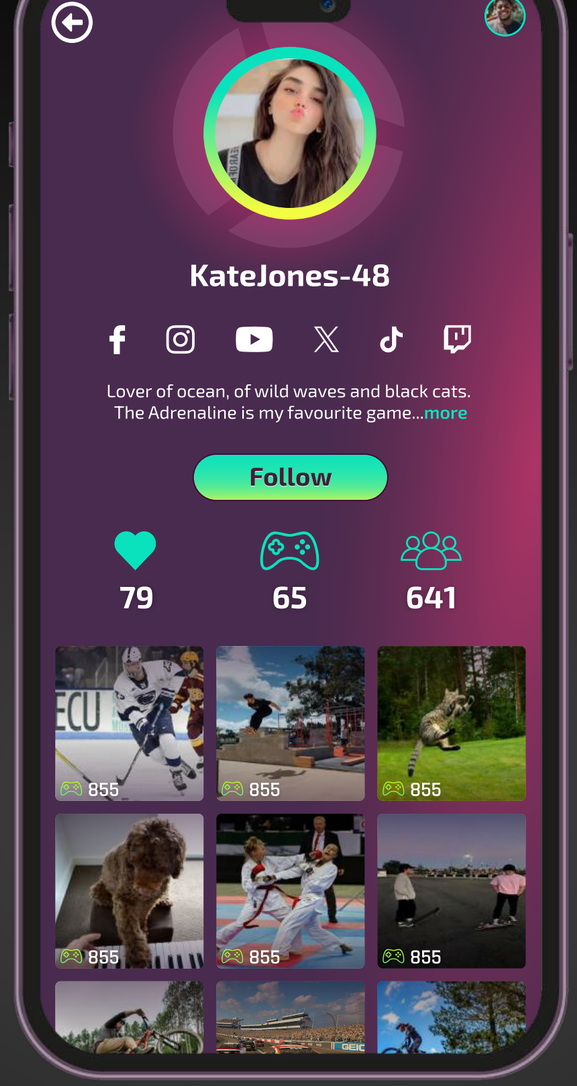
01 — THE MOBILE EXPERIENCE
Designed the gameplay experience and interactions that allowed users to turn video into an interactive game.

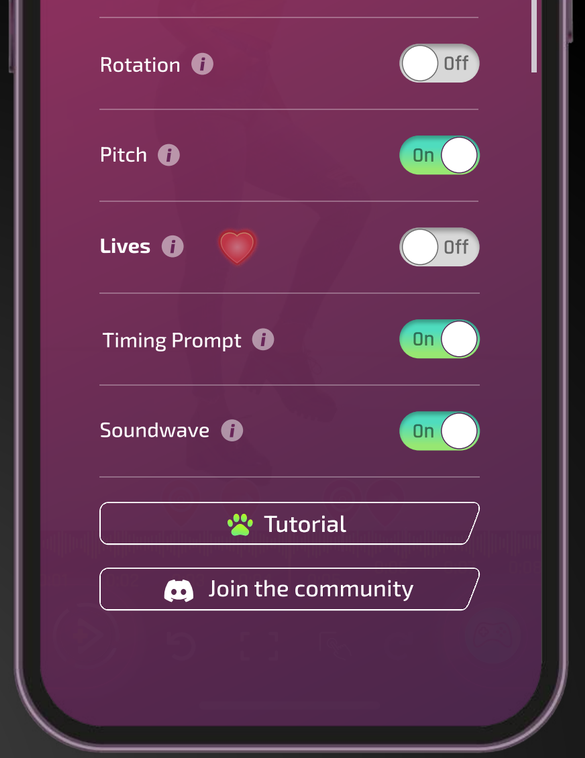
02 — LIVE PARTICIPATION
Created custom games for the judges, allowing them to interact directly with the product during the presentation.

03 — BROADCAST EXPERIENCE
Designed a camera-friendly leaderboard and visual presentation that made gameplay and competition easy to follow on television.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE
A product demonstration should not just describe the experience. It should let people experience the value themselves.




KateJones-48
Lover of ocean, of wild waves and black cats.
The Adrenaline is my favourite game...more
Follow
79
65
641
855
855
855
855
855
855


Rotation
Off
Pitch
On
Lives
Off
Timing Prompt
On
Soundwave
On
Tutorial
Join the community

200%
05:02.220

5. ThomasR 216,300
6. Cinthya07 197,124
7
MattBoy23
148,996
8. ChristineV 97,311
9. Marcus56 50,996

WINNER!!!
Mattboy
148,996
VS
LOSER
Bryan.M-009
98147
WIN
TY'S DIECAST TRUCK
AND $250

LUIS SUAREZ

MEASURABLE IMPACT

+32%
APP DOWNLOADS

+21%
WEBSITE TRAFFIC

NATIONAL EXPOSURE
Overplay reached a broader audience through its Shark Tank Season 15 appearance, bringing the product to viewers beyond traditional gaming communities.

KEY LEARNINGS
Clarity drives adoption.
Innovative products need intuitive experiences that communicate their value quickly.
Context shapes experience design.
The product must work not only in its intended environment but also in the conditions where people discover it.

AI expands the design process.
AI-assisted research and ideation helped explore possibilities, while UX judgment shaped the final direction.

FINAL REFLECTION
The project reinforced the value of connecting product strategy, UX design, and emerging technologies to turn complex ideas into experiences people can understand and engage with.

OUTCOMES & REFLECTION

The Shark Tank experience brought the Overplay platform to a national television audience, creating an opportunity to demonstrate a new approach to interactive video.

OUTCOMES

- Delivered a complete product experience and live demonstration for Shark Tank Season 15.
- Enabled judges to engage directly with custom interactive games.
- Made the product concept tangible through a clear, participatory demonstration.
- Expanded Overplay's brand visibility beyond traditional gaming audiences.

KEY LEARNINGS

- Innovative products need intuitive experiences that communicate their value without extensive explanation.
- A product must work not only in its intended environment but also in the conditions where people discover and experience it.
- AI-assisted research and ideation helped explore possibilities and accelerate creative thinking, while UX judgment shaped the final direction.

FINAL REFLECTION

The project reinforced the value of connecting product strategy, UX design, and emerging technologies to turn complex ideas into experiences people can understand and engage with.